

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 9 6 4

♥ 9 8 3 2

♦ -

♣ Q 10 6 3

♠ K Q 7 3

♥ A 4

♦ Q 9 6 2

♣ A 8 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 8

♥ K Q 10 7 5

♦ 10 8 4

♣ J 9 5 2

♠ A 5 2

♥ J 6

♦ A K J 7 5 3

♣ K 7

West	North	East	South
Pass	1NT	Pass	3♦
Pass	4♦	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♥	Pass	7NT
All Pass			

7NT by North

Lead: ♥K

His ♠ discard makes it very likely that he started with 5 ♠s.

North is to play 7NT. East leads the ♥K.

With 12 obvious tricks your first thought should be that perhaps the ♠s will split 3-3.

Then, your second thought should be that dummy's ♥J is a Threat against East's ♥Q, so if it is East who holds 4 ♠s you will be able to squeeze him.

Since the contract is 7NT you take the first trick with the ♥A.

With one trick in the bag you should test ♦s next. When you play the ♦A West discards a ♠.

You continue with the ♦Q and ♦K, West discarding a ♥ and a ♣.

Since West has shown up with a ♦ void he has become the odds-on favorite to hold the ♠ Guard.

To find out for sure you play ♠A, then ♠Q. Sure enough East discards a ♥ on the second round.

You can't squeeze East in ♥s and ♠s because he doesn't hold the ♠ Guard, West does.

But now a completely new possibility shows up. Say to yourself, over and over, "East must guard ♥s, and West must guard ♠s. Nobody can guard ♣s."

You start playing dummy's ♦ winners.

With one more ♦ in dummy, things look like this.

When you play the ♦5 West must keep both ♠s to guard against your ♠7. So he discards the ♣6, hoping partner can stop that suit.

Your ♠7 is now worthless so you throw it.

East has no problem, (yet), he discards the ♥10.

[showcards N:S5,HJ,CK,C7 E:SJ,ST,CQ,CT S:SK,CA,C8,C4 W:HQ,CJ,C9,C5]

It is now time to pressure East.

Play dummy's ♠5 to your ♠K.

East MUST keep his ♥Q so he releases his ♣5.

And you win the last three tricks with ♣K, ♣A, ♣8.

This is called a Double Squeeze.

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 10 8 3

♥ J 10 7 2

♦ 6 3

♣ 10 6

♠ 9 5 2

♥ 6

♦ A J 9 7 4

♣ Q 8 4 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 6

♥ Q 9 8 4 3

♦ 8 5 2

♣ J 9 7 5

♠ A K 7 4

♥ A K 5

♦ K Q 10

♣ A K 2

West	North	East	South
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Pass

3 ♦

Pass

4NT

Pass

5 ♦

Pass

7NT

All Pass

7NT by South

Lead: ♠ Q

South is to play 7NT. West leads the ♠ Q.

One more winner is needed. Dummy's fourth ♣ is a possibility.

So take the ♠ K and play ♣ A K Q.

West discards a ♠ on the third ♣.

Now you know East guards the ♣ s.

Before tackling ♦ s, see what you can discover about ♠ s.

Play the ♠ A. East discards a ♥ .

East guards the ♣ s. West guards the ♠ s. Nobody can guard the ♥ s.

Play 4 rounds of ♦ s.

[showcards N:S9,H6,D4,C8 E:HQ,H9,H8,CJ S:S7,HA,HK,H5 W:SJ,HJ,HT,H7]

On the fourth ♦ East had to discard a ♥ . You discarded a small ♠ . West discarded a ♠ on the third ♦ and a ♥ on the fourth.

Play dummy's ♦ 4. East cannot throw the ♣ J or he will set up dummy's ♣ 8, so he discards a ♥ .

You discard the ♠ 7.

Now West is squeezed. He cannot discard the ♠ J or he will set up dummy's ♠ 9, so he discards a ♥ .

You win the last three ♥ tricks with another Double Squeeze.

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 6 2
♥ 7 5 2
♦ J 9 8 4 3
♣ J 4

♠ 5

♥ A K J 9 8 3

♦ A 5

♣ K 8 6 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A K J 9 4

♥ 6 4

♦ 10 7 2

♣ Q 10 2

♠ 10 8 7 3

♥ Q 10

♦ K Q 6

♣ A 9 7 5

West	North	East	South
	1♥	1♠	2♣
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♦
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

6♥ by North

Lead: ♠A

Now play the ♦A, ♦K, and ♦Q, discarding the ♣3 from your hand.

Then lead dummy's ♣7 to your ♣K.

[showcards N:ST,CA,C9 E:DJ,D9,CJ S:HA,C8,C6 W:SJ,CQ,CT]

Here you are in your hand.

Only East can guard dummy's ♠10, and only East can guard dummy's ♣9.

So you play your ♥A and East must give up one of his guards. If he holds on to the ♠J then you toss dummy's useless ♠10. If he throws the ♠J then you toss dummy's ♣9.

North is to play 6♥. East leads the ♠A, then ♠K.

When you looked at just your and dummy's cards on the previous page it may have looked impossible to find a twelfth winner.

Even looking at all four hands here it is still very difficult to come up with a plan.

Here's a hint: If East holds 3 ♣s, (and you see that he does), can you squeeze him in ♣s and ♠s?

Of course you ruffed the ♠K.

The big problem with trying to squeeze East in the black suits right now is that West actually holds a ♠ guard. But you can fix that.

Play dummy's ♥Q and ♥10, then ruff a ♠, then pull the last trump.

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A K 9 3 2

♥ 10 4 2

♦ J 9

♣ J 6 4

♠ Q 10

♥ K Q 5 3

♦ A 8 6 3

♣ 8 5 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 8 6 5

♥ J 9 8 6

♦ Q 10 4

♣ Q 10 9

♠ J 7 4

♥ A 7

♦ K 7 5 2

♣ A K 7 3

West	North	East	South
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Pass

2♣

Pass

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♠3

At trick 2 you play a ♠.

Of course West will win this with his ♠K.

And he will no doubt continue with the ♠A and ♠9.

You discard 2 ♦s from dummy and a ♣ from your hand.

East cannot spare either a ♥ or a ♦ so he also throws a ♣.

Remember this position

West will almost surely cash his ♠2.

You and dummy both discard a ♣ and East also must discard a ♣.

It doesn't matter what West plays next, let's say it is a ♣.

In your hand with the ♣K, you now play the ♣A.

East is truly squeezed. If he discards a ♥, dummy's ♥5 will become a winner. but if he discards a ♦ then you will get a third ♦ trick and the contract.

Since it was West who started the squeeze by cashing his last ♠, this is called a Suicide Squeeze. **BUT**, what if West had not cashed that ♠?

Here is the position you were supposed to remember

Suppose West is a really expert defender and avoids the Suicide Squeeze by just refusing to cash his winning ♠. It doesn't matter what else he plays instead, so let us assume it is a ♣.

You win in your hand and establish a ♦ winner by playing ♦A, ♦K, and a small ♦. East wins but cannot reach his partner's hand for that good ♠.

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♠3. East plays the ♠5.

From the opening lead of ♠3 and East's play of ♠5 you should have deduced that West held five ♠s to the A K. Therefore if you lose a trick in any other suit West will be able to take 4 ♠ tricks and defeat you.

You have 8 winners, and if East holds 4+ ♥s AND 3+ ♦s then only he can guard the two suits.

But how can you squeeze him?

The answer to that question is that **YOU** cannot squeeze him.

But maybe you can make his partner do the job for you.

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 10 7 5 4 2
♥ J 10 2
♦ Q 10 4 3
♣ 4

♠ A
♥ A 6 3
♦ K 5
♣ A K Q J 9 8 7

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q 9 6 3
♥ Q 9 8 5
♦ 9
♣ 10 6 2

♠ J 8
♥ K 7 4
♦ A J 8 7 6 2
♣ 5 3

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	3♦
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♦
Pass	5NT	Pass	6♦
Pass	7♣		
All Pass			

7♣ by North

Lead: ♠K

North is to play 7♣. East leads the ♠K.

At first glance this doesn't appear to be a difficult hand. You expect to win the opening lead, pull trumps, then establish a ♦ winner by playing ♦K, ♦A, and ruffing a ♦. As long as they split 3-2 you could reach dummy's ♦ winner with the ♥K.

So you take the ♠A, pull three rounds of trumps and play ♦K.

But when you lead to the ♦A East discards a small ♠.

Time to rethink. You are in dummy now, and you can ruff a ♦, return with the ♥K and ruff another ♦. The last ♦ would be good but you'd have no way to reach it.

Think squeeze instead. Ruff a ♦. This turns the ♦J into a Threat card against West's ♦Q.

But, the ♠J is already a Threat card against East's ♠Q.

Play your ♣J and ♣9, discarding the ♦8 and the ♥4 from dummy.

East can afford to discard the ♠9 and the ♥5.

West can spare his two ♠s.

[showcards N:SJ,HK,H7,DJ E:HJ,HT,H2,DQ S:HA,H6,H3,C8 W:SQ,HQ,H9,H8]

You are there. Play your ♣8.

East cannot throw the ♠Q, so he gives up the ♥8. Dummy's ♠J is of no further value so you dump it.

West cannot throw the ♦Q, so he gives up the ♥2.

And you take the last three tricks with the ♥ suit. There were only two defenders; one of them had to guard ♠s and the other had to guard ♦s. There was nobody left to guard ♥s.

Board 6

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A K J 8 6 5 3 2

♥ 8 6 2

♦ 10

♣ 7

♠ Q 4

♥ J 9 7 3

♦ K 7 5

♣ 8 6 5 2



♠ 10 9 7

♥ 4

♦ Q J 9 4 2

♣ J 10 9 3

♠ -

♥ A K Q 10 5

♦ A 8 6 3

♣ A K Q 4

West

North

East

South

4 ♠

Pass

Pass

2 ♣

Pass

6 ♥

All Pass

6 ♥ by South

Lead: ♠ A

West wins the ♦ 10.

South is to play 6 ♥. West leads the ♠ A.

If ♦s and ♣s split nicely this would be an easy slam. But with that wild ♠ bid by West you can't expect decent splits.

So you ruff the ♠, pull trumps in three rounds, then play ♣ A K and get the bad news when West discards a ♠.

You now know that East guards the ♣s. And since West had 3 ♥s and a very long ♠ suit it is pretty likely that East guards the ♦s also. You will try to squeeze East in ♣s and ♦s, but first you must lose a trick to rectify the count.

So you play a low ♦ from each hand.

It doesn't matter which defender takes the ♦, since either one is going to do the same thing. Assume

He will then play the ♠ K, which you must ruff in your hand.

Now play a small ♦ to dummy's ♦ K.

[showcards N:HJ,D7,C8,C6 E:DQ,DJ,CJ,CT S:DA,D8,CQ,C4 W:SJ,S8,S6,S5]

You are in dummy, ready for the squeeze.

Play dummy's ♥ J.

East gets to choose his own fate - discarding a protector in one of the two suits. Of course, whichever suit he discards you will throw the opposite one.

Yet another slam, courtesy of the Squeeze Play!